

Julison



Philippine Normal University
LICENSURE EXAMINATION FOR TEACHERS (LET)
Refresher Course

WHAT TO EXPECT

GENERAL EDUCATION: ENGLISH

Focus: GRAMMAR

LET Competencies:

1. Analyze the specific grammatical structures intensively
2. Use the English language correctly
3. Communicate in English effectively

Prepared by: PROF. EDILBERTA C. BALA

PART I: CONTENT UPDATE



These review materials consist of eight parts:

- | | |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------|
| I. Subject-Verb Agreement | V. Conditional Sentences |
| II. Verbs | VI. Modals and Similar Expressions |
| III. Nouns | VII. Indirect Report Structures |
| IV. Pronouns | VIII. Parallelisms |

I. SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

The term **agreement** in grammar is used to denote the relationship between the subject and its verb, and the pronoun and its antecedent. This means that a singular subject requires a singular verb and a plural subject takes a plural verb.

1. When two or more singular substantives used as subjects are joined by **and**, a plural form of the verb is required.

Note the following exceptions:

- a. The singular form of the verb is used when each of the singular subjects is considered individually. Usage is most frequent after **each** and **every**.
- b. The singular form of the verb is used when the two singular subjects refer to the same person or thing.

Calamansi juice and tea **is** a refreshing drink.
The secretary and treasurer of the English Club **is** Ofelia.

- c. A compound subject denoting closely related ideas may take a singular verb.

The doctor's patience and tolerance **was** severely taxed.

2. Two or more singular subjects connected by **or**, **nor**, or **but** take a singular verb.

Jun or Mar **is** innocent.
Neither Lina nor Andy **believes** in superstition.

↓
data

Either - union

- The noun after 'or' cannot be the subject.

- with, together with, as well as
interesting

III. NOUNS

A. NUMBER OF NOUNS

- A. In the following sentences, the italicized nouns are generally used in the singular; therefore, they require a singular verb:

1. The actor's *beard* was six inches long.

2. *Food* is necessary for survival.

Note: The plural form *foods* refers to different kinds of foods as in the sentence "Chinese, American, Japanese, and Filipino foods are served at the international fair."

People living in coastal towns consume a lot of *fish*.

Note: When referring to different species of fish, the plural form *fishes* is used; for instance, "In geology the Devonian Period is the age of fishes."

3. All the *fruit* of the mango tree in our backyard fell during the storm.

Note: The plural form *fruits* may be used to refer to different kinds of fruits.

4. There is a lot of *grass* on the lawn.

Note: One may say "a blade of grass" but not "grasses".

5. Despite her youth Miriam has gray *hair*.

Note: *Hair* is not considered a mass noun in the sentence: "I noticed three loose hairs on the collar of Gia's jacket."

6. My brother and I inherited a hectare of residential *land*.

Note: The plural form is used in the expression *public lands* and *foreign lands*.

7. I have some *work* to do.

Note: The plural form is used in *works of art* and in *literary works*.

8. She is annoyed by unsolicited *advice*.

Note: When referring to information or instructions regarding state of affairs, the plural form *advices* is usually used.

- B. In formal, conservative English the following nouns are to be treated as singular. These words do not form their plural by adding *-s*, *es* or by changing *y* to *i* and adding *es*.

baggage	scenery
chalk	information
furniture	machinery
jewelry	pottery

- C. These nouns are always used in the plural form: *clothes*, *means*, *refreshments*, *scissors*, *tactics*, *forceps*, *trousers*, *pliers*, *opera glasses*, *field glasses*, *binoculars*, and *falls* (waterfall).

- D. Nouns plural in form but singular in meaning are *measles*, *news*, *mumps*, *cards* (game), *checkers* (game).

- E. Nouns ending in *ics* are singular when they denote scientific subjects, such as *mathematics*, *physics*, *statistics* (science of assembling, classifying, and tabulating data), *athletics* (art of physical training), *linguistics*, *acoustics* (science of heard sound).

- F. Nouns ending in *ics* are plural when they denote activities or qualities, such as *acoustics*, *acrobatics*, *athletics* (games), *statistics* (facts or data).

G. The following are nouns with their singular and plural forms:

Singular	Plural
memorandum	memoranda, memorandums
agendum (rarely used)	agenda (Latin plural; in English the word agenda is treated as singular.)
datum (rarely used)	data (Facts given; in certain contexts it is permissible to treat the word as a collective noun.)
medium	media
criterion	criteria
phenomenon	phenomena, phenomenons
alumnus (male)	alumni (male)
alumna (female)	alumnae (female)
formula	formulae, formulas
focus	foci, focuses
radius	radii, radiuses
appendix	appendices (to books, documents) appendixes (anatomical)
index	indices (scientific and mathematical signs; British)
analysis	analyses
synthesis	syntheses
axis	axes
phalanx	phalanges, phalanxes
stigma	stigmas, stigmata
cherub	cherubs (lovely children) cherubim (Hebrew plural; angels)
seraph	seraphs seraphim (Hebrew plural)
stratum	stratums, strata (Latin plural)
prima donna	prima donnas, prime donne (Italian plural)
virtuoso	virtuosos, virtuosi (Italian plural)
chateau	chateaux (French plural)
aboriginal (British)	aborigines
aborigine (American)	aboriginals
erratum	errata (used chiefly in errors in printing)
basis	bases
bacillus	bacilli
locus	loci
larva	larvae
antenna	antennae (sense organs attached to the head of an insect) antennas (serials for radio and TV)

- H. The plurals of numbers are indicated by adding an **-s**, **10s**. the plurals of letters are formed by adding an apostrophe and an **-s**: m's, y's i's, a's. The apostrophe is not used in the plurals of abbreviations: PhDs, MAs.
- I. The following nouns are plural: mothers-in-law, passersby, editors in chief, officers in charge, cupfuls, spoonfuls, mouthfuls.

B. POSITION OF MODIFIERS OF NOUNS

Modifiers of nouns may be single words, phrases, or clauses.

The tall man is Mr. Stewart.

The tall man in the brown suit is Mr. Stewart.

The tall man who has on the brown suit is Mr. Stewart.

Single Words and Word Groups that Modify Nouns

- A. Single-word modifiers of nouns ordinarily precede the noun modified.

the	books
my	books
some	books
good	books

- B. When a series of modifiers precedes a noun, the modifiers may be placed in the order illustrated in the following chart.

Articles, Demonstratives Possessives, Indefinite Adjectives	Numerals	Descriptive			Other Nouns	NOUN
		(a) Quality or Charac- teristics	(b) Size or Shape	(c) Color		
the the these her John's the actor's my brother's many several	third first three four first	surprising classic new British modern	narrow	brown black	algebra redwood picture	problem chapters rocks job attitude profile car houses frames

There is more flexibility in the position of descriptive adjectives than is shown by the chart. For example, we may say, "the dirty, narrow street" or "the narrow, dirty street." The order seems to depend upon whether we have in mind a dirty street that is narrow or a narrow street that is dirty.

IV. PRONOUNS

- When the antecedent is **everybody**, **each**, **either**, **everyone**, **neither**, nobody, a person, a singular pronoun is preferred. Informal English sometimes uses the plural pronoun.

Each has **his** own solution to the problem.

Everybody has **his** responsibility to attend to.

Nobody has done **his** work on time.

Everyone was keeping **his** fingers crossed.

A person has **his** own ideas about how peace and reconciliation can be achieved.

- When the antecedents **each**, **either**, or **neither** are followed by a plural modifier, a similar pronoun is preferred. In colloquial usage the plural modifier often leads to a plural pronoun.

Each of the girls believes **she** is going to qualify for the scholarship.

Neither of the candidates would admit **his** defeat.

Either of the two male passengers has lost **his** ticket.

Note: The masculine form of the pronoun is generally used when the sex of the antecedent is unknown or when the antecedent refers to both sexes.

Everyone is expected to **his** share.

The **boys** and **girls** have been made to understand that **everybody** must do **his** duty.

- With the impersonal **one** as antecedent, the third person pronoun is **generally** used.

One must create **his** own opportunity in order to get ahead.

One cannot testify against **himself**.

Note: In a very formal style, the impersonal pronoun **one** is sometimes used throughout.

- When the antecedent is a collective noun, the pronoun may either be singular or plural; if the group is considered as a unit, the singular form of the pronoun is used; if the individual members are thought of, the plural form of the pronoun is used.

The committee reversed **itself**.

The committee may have **their** disagreements but **they** always reach a consensus.

- None** means "no one"; however, current usage permits the use of either the singular or the plural forms of the pronoun with it.

None of the lawyers has submitted **his** memorandum (or, have submitted **their** memorandums).

6. When the antecedent is a person, the relative pronoun **who** is used; when the antecedent is a thing, **which** is used; for persons, animals, and things as antecedents, **that** is used.

A **man who** has filled professorial chairs in four universities and has written several successful books is supposed to have brains of special quality.

A **woman that** I know practices psychoanalysis.

A word has its denotation, a certain set of **things which** it stands for and points to.

Note: Current usage sometimes makes this distinction: **that** is used for restrictive clauses; **which** is used for nonrestrictive clauses.

The book that you need is in the cabinet. (restrictive clause)

The book, which you are supposed to return to the library, has been taken by Delia.

7. The possessive form **whose** is theoretically reserved for persons, but in practice it is often used when the form of **which** appears awkward.

The problem is especially complex when we deal with **value words** like "good," "evil," "elegant" **whose** principal function is to indicate the approval or disapproval of the speaker.

A. Using subject pronouns: Who, Which, That

	I thanked the woman. She helped me.				In (a): I thanked the woman = an independent clause who helped me = an adjective clause The adjective clause modifies the noun woman .
(a)	I thanked the woman	who	helped me.		In (a): who is the subject of the adjective clause.
(b)	I thanked the woman	that	helped me.		In (b): that is the subject of the adjective clause. Note: (a) and (b) have the same meaning.
	The book is mine. It is on the table.				who = used for people which = used for things that = used for both people and things
(c)	The book	which	is on the table	is mine.	
(d)	The book	that	is on the table	is mine.	

B. Using object pronouns: Who(m), Which, That

1. Pronoun used as the object of a verb The man was Mr. Jones. I saw him .					Notice in the examples: the adjective clause pronouns are placed at the beginning of the clause. (General guideline: Place an adjective clause pronoun as close as possible to the noun it modifies.)
(e)	The man	who(m)	I saw	was Mr. Jones.	In (e): who is usually used instead of whom , especially in speaking. Whom is generally used only in very formal English.
(f)	The man	that	I saw	was Mr. Jones.	
(g)	The man	$\emptyset$	I saw	was Mr. Jones.	
The movie wasn't very good. We saw it last night.					In (g) and (j): An object pronoun is often omitted from an adjective clause. (A subject pronoun, however, may not be omitted.)
(h)	The movie	which	we saw last night	wasn't very good.	who(m) = used for people which = used for things that = used for both people and things
(i)	The movie	that	we saw last night	wasn't very good.	
(j)	The movie	$\emptyset$	we saw last night	wasn't very good.	

Using Whose

I know the man. His bicycle was stolen. ↓ (k) I know the man whose bicycle was stolen.	Whose is used to show possession. It carries the same meaning as other possessive pronouns used as adjectives: <i>his, her, its, and their</i>. Like <i>his, her, its, and their</i>, whose is connected to a noun: <i>his bicycle</i> → <i>whose bicycle</i> <i>her composition</i> → <i>whose composition</i>
The student writes well. I read her composition. ↓ (l) The student whose composition I read writes well.	Both whose and the noun it is connected to are placed at the beginning of the adjective clause. Whose cannot be omitted.
Mr. Catt has a painting. Its value is inestimable.	Whose usually modifies "people," but it may also be used to modify "things," as in (m).
(m) Mr. Catt has a painting whose value is inestimable.	

V. CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

A. Summary of basic verb form usage in conditional sentences

Meaning of the "If Clause"	Verb form in the "If Clause"	Verb Form in the "Result Clause"	
True in the present / future	<i>simple present</i>	<i>simple present</i> <i>simple future</i>	(a) If I have enough time, I write to my parents every week. (b) If I have enough time tomorrow, I will write to my parents.
Untrue in the present/future	<i>simple past</i>	would + <i>simple form</i>	(c) If I had enough time now, I would write to my parents. (<i>In truth, I do not have enough time, so I will not write to them.</i>)
Untrue in the past	<i>past perfect</i>	would have + <i>past participle</i>	(d) If I had had enough time, I would have written to my parents yesterday. (<i>In truth, I did not have enough time, so I did not write to them.</i>)

B. True in the present or future

(e) If I don't eat breakfast, I always get hungry during class. (f) Water freezes (will freeze) if the temperature goes below 32°F/0°C. (g) If I don't eat breakfast tomorrow morning, I will get hungry during class. (h) If the weather is nice tomorrow, we will go on a picnic.	In (e): The simple present is used in the result clause to express a habitual activity or situation. In (f): Either the simple present or the simple future is used in the result clause to express an established, predictable fact. In (g) and (h): The simple future is used in the result clause when the sentence concerns a particular activity or situation in the future. Note: The simple present, not the simple future, is used in the "if clause."
--	---

C. Using progressive verb forms

Notice the use of progressive verb forms in the following examples. Even in conditional sentences, progressive verb forms are used in progressive situations.

(a) True:	It is raining right now, so I will not go for a walk.
(b) Conditional:	If it were not raining right now, I would go for a walk.
(c) True:	I am not living in Chile. I am not working at a bank.
(d) Conditional:	If I were living in Chile, I would be working at a bank.
(e) True:	It was raining yesterday afternoon, so I did not go for a walk.
(f) Conditional:	If it had not been raining , I would have gone for a walk.
(g) True:	I was not living in Chile last year. I was not working at a bank.
(h) Conditional:	If I had been living in Chile last year, I would have been working at a bank.

D. Using "mixed time" in conditional sentences

Frequently the time in the "if clause" and the time in the "result clause" are different: One clause may be in the present and the other in the past. Notice that past and present times are mixed in the sentences in the following examples.

(a) True:	I did not eat breakfast several hours ago, so I am hungry now.
(b) Conditional:	If I had eaten breakfast several hours ago, I would not be hungry now. (past) (present)
(c) True:	He is not a good student. He did not study for the test yesterday.
(d) Conditional:	If he were a good student, he would have studied for the test. (present) (past)

E. Using could, might, and should

(a) If I were a bird, I could fly home.	In (a): could fly = would be able to fly
(b) If I could sing as well as you, I would join the opera.	In (b): could sing = were able to sing
(c) If I'd had enough money, I could have gone to Florida for vacation.	In (c): could have gone = would have been able to go
(d) If I don't get a scholarship, I might get a job instead of going to graduate school next fall.	In (d): I might get = maybe I will get
(e) If you were a better student, you might get better grades.	In (e): you might get = maybe you would get
(f) If you had told me about your problem, I might have been able to help you.	In (f): I might have been = maybe I would have been
(g) If John should call , tell him I'll be back around five.	In (g): If John should call indicates a little more uncertainty or doubt than If John calls , but the meaning of the two is basically the same.
(h) If there should be another world war, the continued existence of the human race would be in jeopardy.	In (h): If there should be indicates more uncertainty or doubt than If there were .

F. Implied Conditions

(a) I would have gone with you, but I had to study. (Implied condition ... if I hadn't had to study)	Often the "if clause" is implied, not stated. Conditional verbs are still used in the "result clause."
(b) I never would have succeeded without your help. (Implied condition: ... if you hadn't helped me)	
(c) She ran; <i>otherwise</i> , she would have missed her bus.	Conditional verbs are frequently used following otherwise . In (c), the implied "if clause" is: If <i>she had not run</i> ...

G. Verb forms following Wish

	Verb form in "True" Sentence	Verb form following <i>Wish</i>	
A wish about the future	(a) She will not tell me.	I <i>wish</i> (that) she would tell me.	<i>Wish</i> is used when the speaker wants reality to be different, to be exactly the opposite. Verb forms similar to those in conditional sentences are used. Notice the examples. <i>Wish</i> is followed by a noun clause. The use of <i>that</i> is optional. Usually it is omitted in speaking.
	(b) He isn't going to be here.	I <i>wish</i> he were going to be here.	
	(c) She can't come tomorrow.	I <i>wish</i> she could come tomorrow.	
A wish about the present	(d) I don't know French.	I <i>wish</i> I knew French.	
	(e) It is raining right now.	I <i>wish</i> it weren't raining right now.	
	(f) I can't speak Japanese.	I <i>wish</i> I could speak Japanese.	
A wish about the past	(g) John didn't come .	I <i>wish</i> John had come .	
	(h) Mary couldn't come .	I <i>wish</i> Mary could have come .	

VI. SUMMARY CHART OF MODALS AND SIMILAR EXPRESSIONS

Auxiliary	Uses	Present/Future	Past
<i>may</i>	(1) polite request	May I borrow your pen?	
	(2) formal permission	You may leave the room.	
	(3) less than 50% certainty	— Where's John? He may be at the library.	He may have been at the library.
<i>might</i>	(1) less than 50% certainty	— Where's John? He might be at the library.	He might have been at the library.
	(2) polite request (rare)	Might I borrow your pen?	
<i>should</i>	(1) advisability	I should study tonight.	I should have studied last night.
	(2) 90% certainty	She should do well on the test. (future only, not present)	She should have done well on the test.
<i>ought to</i>	(1) advisability	I ought to study tonight.	I ought to have studied last night.
	(2) 90% certainty	She ought to do well on the test. (future only, not present)	She ought to have done well on the test.
<i>had better</i>	(1) advisability with threat of bad result	You had better be on time, or we will leave without you.	(past form uncommon)
<i>be supposed to</i>	(1) expectation	Class is supposed to begin at 10.	Class was supposed to begin at 10.
<i>be to</i>	(1) strong expectation	You are to be here at 9:00.	You were to be here at 9:00
<i>must</i>	(1) strong necessity	I must go to class today.	I had to go to class yesterday.
	(2) prohibition (negative)	You must not open that door.	
	(3) 95% certainty	Mary isn't in class. She must be sick. (present only)	Mary must have been sick yesterday.
<i>have to</i>	(1) necessity	I have to go to class today.	I had to go to class yesterday.
	(2) lack of necessity (negative)	I don't have to go to class today.	I didn't have to go to class yesterday.
<i>have got to</i>	(1) necessity	I have got to go to class today.	I had to go to class yesterday.
<i>will</i>	(1) 100% certainty	He will be here at 6:00. (future only)	
	(2) willingness	— The phone's ringing. I'll get it.	
	(3) polite request	Will you please pass the salt?	
<i>be going to</i>	(1) 100% certainty	He is going to be here at 6:00 (future only)	
	(2) definite plan	I 'm going to paint my bedroom. (future only)	I was going to paint my room, but I didn't have time.

Auxiliary	Uses	Present/Future	Past
can	(1) ability/possibility	I can run fast.	I could run fast when I was a child, but now I can't.
	(2) informal permission	You can use my car tomorrow.	
	(3) informal polite request	Can I borrow your pen?	
	(4) impossibility (negative only)	That can't be true!	That can't have been true!
could	(1) past ability		I could run fast when I was a child.
	(2) polite request	Could I borrow your pen? Could you help me?	
	(3) suggestion	-- I need help in math. You could talk to your teacher.	You could have talked to your teacher.
	(4) less than 50% certainty	-- Where's John? He could be at home.	He could have been at home.
	(5) impossibility (negative only)	That couldn't be true!	That couldn't have been true!
be able to	(1) ability	I am able to help you. I will be able to help you.	I was able to help him.
would	(1) polite request	Would you please pass the salt? Would you mind if I left early?	
	(2) preference	I would rather go to the park than stay home.	I would rather have gone to the park.
	(3) repeated action in the past		When I was a child, I would visit my grandparents every weekend.
used to	(1) repeated action in the past		I used to visit my grandparents every weekend.
shall	(1) polite question to make a suggestion	Shall I open the window?	
	(2) future with "I" or "we" as subject	I shall arrive at nine. (will = more common)	

VII. INDIRECT REPORT STRUCTURES

1. An indirect report structure is used to show that you are reporting what someone said or wrote in your own words rather than in the words they actually used. You can also use indirect report structures to report what someone thought or felt.

indirect report structures with reporting verbs

2. There are several different types of indirect report structures. The first ones discussed here are those which involve a reporting verb. This kind of indirect report structure consists of two parts: the reporting clause, which carries the reporting signal and contains the reporting verb, and the reported clause, which carries the message. The two-clause structure is sometimes called **indirect speech** or **reported speech**. In each of the following examples, the reported clause is underlined; the rest of the sentence is the reporting clause.

The nurse said that I could see him.

The friend asked what had happened to Clara's mother.

I asked him one morning if he had slept well.

Somebody's told you to talk to me.

Last night he admitted experiencing difficulties in his marriage.

VIII. PARALLELISM

Make sentence elements parallel in thought and in form or grammatical structure.

- Faulty:* On weekends Carlos is either in the library or playing tennis.
Parallel: On weekends Carlos is either browsing in the library or playing tennis.
- Faulty:* He enjoys reading in the evening, relaxing on the seashore, and athletics now and then.
Parallel: He enjoys reading in the evening, relaxing on the seashore, and participating in athletics now and then.
- Faulty:* He spoke simply, directly, and with eloquence.
Parallel: He spoke simply, directly, and eloquently.
- Faulty:* The story tells of the honesty and promotion of a policeman.
Parallel: The story tells of the honesty of a policeman and of his promotion.
- Faulty:* At last he saw a light, and voices were heard.
Parallel: At last he saw a light and heard voices.

REFERENCES:

- Alcantara, Rebecca and Josephine Cabanilla. 1990. *Effective Writing*. Quezon City: Phoenix Publishing.
- Azar, Betty Schramper. 1989. *Understanding and Using English Grammar*. Englewood Cliffs, New Jersey: A Simeon and Schuster Company.
- Hayden, Rebecca E., Dorothy W. Pilgrim and Aurora Q. Haggard. *Mastering American English*. New York: Prentice-Hall, Inc.
- Heaton, J.B. 1991. *Writing English Language Tests*. New York: Longman Group UK Limited.
- Hornby, A.S. 1995. *Guide to Patterns and Usage in English*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Owen, Nicholas, Ma. Luz Vilches, and Edilberta Bala, et. al. 1994. *Communicate Effectively in English*. Makati, Metro Manila: Diwa Scholastic Press, Inc.
- Pyle, Michael A. and Mary Ellen Muñoz, 1983. *CLIFFS TOEFL Preparation Guide*.
- Thompson, Geoff. 1994. *English Guides, 5 - Reporting*. London: Harper Collins Publisher.



PART II: ANALYZING TEST ITEMS

Directions: Each sentence is an incomplete sentence. Four words or phrases, marked by (A), (B), (C), (D), are given beneath each sentence. Choose the one word or phrase that best completes the sentence. Write the letter on the blank provided before the number.

1. The Board of Judges chose _____ as Miss Philippines for 2005-2006.
- A. the second pretty brown-eyed cute contestant
 - B. the second brown-eyed pretty cute contestant
 - C. the pretty second brown-eyed cute contestant
 - D. the brown-eyed pretty second cute contestant

The answer is A. The rule of modification is: Article + Numeral + Quality Adj. + Size/Shape + Color + Noun. Choice B is incorrect because the adjective pretty should come before brown-eyed. Choice C is incorrect because the numeral second should come before pretty. Choice D is incorrect because second should come before pretty and brown-eyed should precede cute.

2. Maria did not do well in class because _____
- A. she studied bad
 - B. she was not good study wise
 - C. she was a badly student
 - D. she failed to study properly

The answer is D. Choice A is incorrect because adjectives (e.g. bad) are not used to modify verbs (e.g. study) the verb studied should be modified by an adverb, badly. Choice B is incorrect because it is never correct to say wise with a noun or verb to mean in relation to. Choice C is incorrect because badly is an adverb and it cannot modify the noun student.

3. The residents were told to evacuate their houses immediately _____.
- A. at the time when the water began to go up
 - B. when the water began to rise
 - C. when up was going to the water
 - D. in the time when the water raised

The answer is B. Choice D includes the wrong verb raised; A incorrectly uses the time when. It should be the time that because the time when is redundant; Choice C uses incorrect word order.

4. He entered a seminary _____
- A. when he had eighteen years
 - B. when eighteen years were his age
 - C. at the age of eighteen
 - D. at age eighteen years old

The answer is C. There are only a few possibilities for expressing age in English: 1) when he was eighteen (years old), 2) at (age) eighteen, and 3) at the age of eighteen. Choice C follows the rule.

5. The little boy ran away in fright _____
- A. when he heard the movement in the bushes
 - B. the movement among the bushes having been heard
 - C. after it was hearing moving inside of the bushes
 - D. when he has heard that something moved in the bushes

The answer is A. Choice B is incorrect because there is a need for an adverbial subordinator. Active voice improve ... active voice is needed. Choice C makes improper use of the past progressive. D is verbose and makes improper use of the present perfect.

6. Henry will dust the furniture, _____
☐ A scrub the floor, prepare the meal, washing the dishes
☐ B scrubbing the floor, preparing the meal, and washing the dishes
☐ C scrub the floor, prepare the meal, and wash the dishes
☐ D to scrub the floor, prepare the meal, and wash the dishes
7. A good college student must know _____
☐ A how to study effectively
☐ B to study hard
☐ C to be a good college student
☐ D the way of efficiency in study
8. The manager told his secretary that he would return _____
☐ A at the nearest early possibility
☐ B as soon as possible
☐ C at the earliest that it could be possible
☐ D as early as it would be possible
9. The jury has met and _____
☐ A its decision was reached at
☐ B they have reached a decision
☐ C it has formulated themselves some opinions
☐ D it has reached a decision
10. There has not been a positive response to our request for an increase of salary, _____?
☐ A has there
☐ B hasn't it
☐ C hasn't there
☐ D does there
11. Tessie wanted to serve some coffee to her friends; however, _____
☐ A she was lacking in amount of the sugar
☐ B she did not have much sugar
☐ C there was not a great amount of the sugar
☐ D she hadn't many sugar
12. The facilities of the older building _____
☐ A are as good as or better than those of the new building
☐ B is as good or better than the new building
☐ C are as good as or better than the new building
☐ D is as good or better than the new building
13. Neither Chito nor his nephews _____ a health certificate for tomorrow's job fair.
☐ A needs
☐ B need
☐ C is needing
☐ D has need
14. A special award was given to a _____ pupil from Roxas Elementary School
☐ A five years old
☐ B five year old
☐ C five years'
☐ D five year's old
15. There were two small rooms in the house, _____ served as coffee nook.
☐ A the smallest of which
☐ B the smaller of which
☐ C the smaller of them
☐ D smallest of that

Part B. Each item is a brief conversation between two persons. One or more words have been omitted in each conversation. Choose the one word or phrase that you would use to complete the conversation. Write the letter on the blank provided before the number.

16. "Were any of the children hurt in the fire?"
"No. The rescuers got _____ to save them".
☐ A enough quickly there
☐ B quickly enough there
☐ C there enough quickly
☐ D there quickly enough

17. "Was the household chore difficult?"
"Yes, we found _____"
☐ A. it hard for doing the work
☒ B. the work hard to do
☐ C. the work hard for doing
☐ D. hard to do the work

18. "Will you and your sister join the field trip?"
"I imagine _____"
☐ A. it
☒ B. so
☐ C. we'll
☐ D. that

* No contractive form at the end of the sentence.

19. "No one was prepared for the oral examination."
"We _____ have read the exercises last night."
☐ A. would
☒ B. ought
☐ C. can
☐ D. should

20. "I am returning these ten journals of linguistics."
"Would you mind _____ on the table, please?"
☐ A. to put them
☒ B. put them
☐ C. putting them
☐ D. to them putting

Part C. Read each question. Choose the sentence that best answers the question.

21. Which woman actually saw her friend?
☒ A. Nora called up her friend when she came to Manila.
☐ B. Betsy called on her friend when she came to Manila.
☐ C. Angie called for her friend when she came to Manila.
☐ D. Mavic called her friend up when she came to Manila.

call of - stop
call by - ask someone to
ask

22. Which man had been working in the dark?
☐ A. Nardo turned off the lights before leaving the office.
☒ B. Oscar turned on the lights before leaving the office.
☐ C. Joel turned in the lights before leaving the office.
☐ D. Rey turned out the lights before leaving the office.

23. Which of the four men is a thief?
☐ A. Dido ran down with some valuable books.
☒ B. Nestor ran across some valuable books.
☐ C. Noni ran away with some valuable books.
☐ D. Tomas ran into some valuable books.

24. Which woman used the dictionary?
☐ A. Nena looked over the new vocabulary before starting her reading.
☒ B. Alice looked up the new vocabulary before starting her reading.
☐ C. Lydia looked into the new vocabulary before starting her reading.
☐ D. Pina looked for the new vocabulary before starting her reading.

25. Which girl is more polite?
☐ A. Josie talks back to her parents.
☒ B. Charito never talks to her parents.
☐ C. Elena never talks back to her parents.
☐ D. Zeny does not talk to her parents.

PART III: ENHANCING TEST TAKING SKILLS



Part A. Each sentence contains four words or phrases underlined, marked A, B, C and D. Select the underlined word or phrase which is incorrect or unacceptable. Write the letter on the blank provided before the number.

1. When I was younger, I can run fast.
A B C D
2. I was going to play the piano, but I don't have time.
A B C D
3. If I was a bird, I could fly home.
A B C D *impossible = were, would word*
4. He would have visited you, but he don't know that you were at home.
A B C D
5. The president said that I can see him.
A B C D
6. I asked her one afternoon if she has paid the tuition fee.
A B C D
7. He wrote legibly, clearly and with neatness.
A B C D
8. Mama likes cooking in the evening, swimming in the morning and music now and then.
A B C D
9. Pina hates a postman who deliver letters outside the gate.
A B C D
10. Nalding is one of those engineers who works hard and deliver outputs promptly.
A B C D

Part B. Choose the one word or phrase that best completes the sentence. Write the letter on the blank provided before the number.

11. I usually watch the television while I _____ for the food.
A. am waiting C. waited
B. waiting D. waits
12. Libby _____ while he was waiting for his wife.
A. sung C. sing
B. sang D. sings
13. Ruth is going to wait until Victor _____ his tea.
A. finished C. had finished
B. finish D. has finished
14. Elsa _____ French since she has been attending weekend classes.
A. has learned C. have learned
B. had learned D. was learning

15. The visitors _____ just arrived when the receptionist called the officials.
A. has C. have
B. had D. were

Part C. Choose the one word or phrase that you would use to complete the conversation.

16. Does your friend _____ a secret.
Yes, she has a secret.
A. have C. had
B. has D. was
17. Did you _____ to the beauty parlor?
Of course. It is my hobby.
A. going C. goes
B. went D. go
18. Who won the debate?
A. The first handsome blue-eyed guy
B. The blue-eyed first handsome guy
C. The handsome blue-eyed first guy
D. The first blue-eyed handsome guy
19. What did you claim at the airport?
A. baggages
B. several baggages
C. three pieces of baggage
D. three pieces of baggages
20. How can unity in this organization be achieved?
A. Each have their own ideas about unity.
B. Each had his own ideas about unity.
C. Each have his own ideas about unity.
D. Each has his own ideas about unity.
21. Have the teachers submitted their reports?
A. None of the teachers have submitted their reports.
B. None of the teachers had submitted their reports.
C. None of the teachers has submitted his reports.
D. None of the teacher has submitted his reports.
22. Who did you thank at the party?
A. I thanked the waiter who help me.
B. I thanked the waiter who helped me.
C. I thank the waiter who help me.
D. I thank the waiter who helped me.
23. What kind of party was it last night?
A. The party whom I attended was colourful.
B. The party who I attended was colourful.
C. The party that I attended was colourful.
D. The party whose I attended was colourful.
24. Did you have a big audience in the concert?
A. A number of students were at the concert.
B. A number of students was at the concert.
C. The number of students were at the concert.
D. The number of student was at the concert.
25. Who write interesting scripts?
A. The director, as well as his assistants and actors writes interesting scripts.
B. The director, as well as his assistants and actors write interesting scripts.
C. The director, as well as his assistants and actors were writing interesting scripts.
D. The director, as well as his assistants and actors wrote interesting scripts.

Had - describe the past events

intervening phrase

- negative explanatory phrase
- either ..OR/Neither ..NOR - correlative relatives
 - indefinite pronouns

Not Victor but Jaime **was** elected president of the council.

Not only his best friend but even his brother **considers** Jim at fault for the loss of the bag.

3. When one of the two subjects joined by **or**, **nor**, or **but** is singular and the other is plural, the verb agrees with the nearer subject.

Neither Art nor his friends **are** interested in joining the rally.

Not only the girls but also their mother **refuses** to give up.

4. When two subjects joined by **or** or **nor** differ in person, the verb agrees with the nearer subject.

Either Vicky or I **have** been granted the scholarship grant.

Neither Eppie or you **were** nominated for secretary of the student council.

The indefinite pronouns **each**, **neither**, **either**, **everyone**, **everybody** are singular in Formal English; therefore, they are used with singular verbs.

Plural - **both**, **few**, **many**, **others**, **several**

Singular or plural - **All**, **any**, **enough**, **more**, **most**, **none**, **some**

Expressions denoting quantity, sums, fractions may be considered singular, although they are apparently plural, provided the focus is on the whole amount rather than on the individual units.

In 1970 two pesos **was** equivalent to one dollar.

About two-thirds of the pie **is** left.

Note that fractions take a singular verb if the object of the **of**-phrase is singular; they take a plural verb if the object of the **of**-phrase is plural.

Correct: Three-fourths of the milk **has been** spilled.

Correct: Three-fourths of the bananas **are** spoiled.

Either the singular or the plural verb is acceptable in sentences using mathematical computations.

Four and eight **is** twelve.

Four and eight **are** twelve.

Ten times six **is** sixty.

Ten times six **are** sixty.

8. Collective nouns such as **police**, **committee**, **family**, **jury**, **audience**, **class**, **team** are treated as plural if the individual members are thought of separately; singular, if the group as a unit is considered.

The police **is** responsible for peace and order in the community.

The police **have** received their pay envelopes for the month.

NOTE: This convention also applies to such nouns as **rest**, **remainder**, **a number of** (meaning "several" or "many").

Correct: A number of pupils are absent.

The number of pupils in the audience is big.

9. Nouns singular in meaning but plural in form generally require a singular verb. Examples of these nouns are **mathematics**, **measles**, **mumps**, **physics**, **aeronautics**, **news**, **dynamics**, **statics**, **whereabouts**.

10. **There is** should be followed by a singular noun or a mass noun and **there are** by a plural noun or a count noun.

There is much money in circulation.

There are people in love with themselves.

Note that in formal usage, a compound subject composed of several singular nouns takes a plural verb.

Examples:

On the crown of the hill, there are a miniature cathedral and a miniature governor's palace.

- Toynbee

There are a man, a woman and a child in the room.

PAST PROGRESSIVE affirmative

I/He	was	playing tennis. traveling by bus. swimming.
She/It		
You/We	were	
They		

negative

I/He	was not	playing tennis. traveling by bus. swimming.
She/It	wasn't	
You/We	were not	
They	weren't	

question form

Was	I/he	playing tennis? traveling by bus? swimming?
Were	she/it	
	you/we	
	they	

FUTURE affirmative

I	will	fall asleep soon. do it tomorrow. take a holiday.
We	'll	
	shall	
You/They	will	
He/She/It	'll	

negative

I	will not	fall asleep soon. do it tomorrow. take a holiday.
We	won't	
You/They	will not	
He/She/It	won't	

question form

Will	I/we	fall asleep soon? do it tomorrow? take a holiday?
Shall		
Will	you/they	
	he/she/it	

PAST PROGRESSIVE AND PAST SIMPLE

The **past progressive** shows an incomplete action.

The **past simple** shows a complete action.

PRESENT PERFECT

affirmative/negative

I/You	have	completed the project. written a letter. lived here since 1984.
We/They	have not haven't	
He/She	has	known Bong for six years.
It	hasn't	

question form

Have	I/You	completed the project? written a letter?
	We/They	
Has	He/she	lived here since 1984? known Bong for six years?
	It	

The present perfect shows:

1. An activity that is still happening in the present.
I have lived here for five years. ie I still live here.
2. A past activity that still has an effect in the present.
I have broken my leg.
The important thing is that the leg is broken.

The past simple shows:

1. An activity that has stopped.
I lived here for five years. = I don't live here now.
2. The time when something happened.
I broke my leg last year.
The important thing is the time when you broke it.

B. SEQUENCE OF TENSES

1. The tense of the verb in the main clause ordinarily controls the tense of the verb in a clause modifying the verb.

- a. Sequence with the simple present in the main clause:

The secretary always **leaves** as soon as her boss **goes** home.

(**Leaves** and **goes** both express customary activity in the present.)

I usually **read** the newspaper while I **am waiting** for the bus.

(**Read** expresses customary activity in the present; **am waiting** emphasizes the continuous nature of the activity.)

He never **goes** home before he **has finished** his work.

(**Goes** expresses customary activity in the present; **has finished** emphasizes completion of the activity before the customary activity in the main clause.)

- b. Sequence with the simple past in the main clause:

He **sat** there until the telephone **rang**.

(**Sat** and **rang** both express completed activities in the past.)

The telephone **rang** while he **was sitting** there.

(**Rang** expresses a completed activity in the past; **was sitting** emphasizes the continuous nature of the activity at the time of the past activity in the main clause.)

He **left** after he **had finished** the experiment.

(**Left** expresses a completed activity in the past; **had finished** indicates an activity that was completed before the past activity in the main clause.)

- c. Sequence with the past progressive in the main clause:

They **were still waiting** when I **got** there.

(**Were waiting** expresses a continuous activity in the past at the time of the past activity expressed by **got**.)

John **was still going** to school while his brother **was becoming** a successful lawyer.

(**Was going** and **was becoming** both express continuous activities at an implied point of time in the past.)

- d. Sequence with the future in the main clause:

We'll **stay** here until the rain **lets up** a bit.

(**Will stay** expresses an activity that will continue until the future activity expressed by **lets up**.)

I'll **think** it over while I'm **having** my lunch.

(**Will think** expresses an activity that will continue during the future activity expressed by **am having**.)

I'm **going to wait** until John **has finished** his coffee.

(**Am going to wait** expresses an activity that will continue until completion of the future activity expressed by **has finished**.)

- e. Sequence with the present perfect in the main clause:

Since the present perfect in the main clause expresses activity that began in the past and that may continue through the present and possibly into the future, the verb in the other clause may express an activity that exists or occurs in past, present, or future time.

I **have felt** much better since I **have been** here.

(**Have felt** and **have been** both express activities that began in the past and may continue into the future.)

I **have learned** a lot since I **have been attending** night school.

(**Have learned** and **have been attending** both express activities that began in the past and may continue into the future; **have been attending** emphasizes the continuous nature of the activity.)

He **has played** the trumpet since he was a child.

(**Has played** expresses an activity that began and has continued from the point of time in the past indicated by **since he was a child**.)

He **has worked** very hard so that he **will be able to finish** his thesis by June.

(**Has worked** expresses an activity that began in the past for the purpose of achieving the future activity expressed by **will be able to finish**.)

- f. Sequence with the past perfect or the future perfect in the main clause:

The past perfect is ordinarily used only in relation to another past activity or point of time in the past; the future perfect, only in relation to another present or future activity or point of time.

We **had just come** in when you **called**.

(**Had come** expresses an activity that occurred before the other activity in the past expressed by **called**.)

We'll **have already gone** before you **get back**.

(**Will have gone** expresses an activity that will be completed before the activity expressed by **get back**.)